

Delta Electronics – The Power House of Data Center Business in India

Deepak Singh Thakur, Business Head, CISBU-MCIS India & SAARC Region, Delta Electronics India Private Limited, a market leader in the industry, is set to chart a dynamic strategy in bringing about a paradigm shift in the digital space in India. He shares with BT the strength, scope and future of Delta's data centre vertical/segment addressing the digitization needs of the Indian market and expanding its market base with sustainability at the core in whatever the company does.



■ Deepak Singh Thakur

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Businesses are recovering from the aftermath of the Covid pandemic. How did Delta survive the challenges and the take-away from the experience?

In the last two years of the Covid pandemic we have witnessed relationships of companies- viz- customers being impacted across industries. Lockdowns and drastic curtailing of movement posed the gravest challenges compelling industries to explore innovative ways to engage with their customers. Delta promptly switched to online

interactions with key accounts who readily adapted to the new mode of communication realising that it is the only way forward. A perceptible impact on the supply chain, logistics and price hike were other areas of concern. We also learnt lessons on cost saving, how to optimise procurement and plan travel strategy, and the fact that we could still function on reduced budgets i.e., without being expensive we can still deliver. Pruning superfluous expenses, which were conventionally thought to be necessary or indispensable, was another big change.

How did Delta's business fare during the pandemic?

We have experienced impacts of two kinds – the increase in demand and drop in demand. As we cater to data centre as a customer segment, we witnessed a marked boost in demand for online communication. So, that is where Delta's Data Centre market share segment is doing very well. On the other side we faced the brunt of huge government projects getting delayed and by adopting 'work from home' strategy new projects of corporate campuses were put on hold or shelved. With mobility being affected, manufacturing/production was affected and also demand for many products came down. Delta came out unscathed because we were catering to high demand from data centre and IT segment, compensating other setbacks. Even in crisis, Delta moved on an even keel.

With digital interface increasing rapidly, what future do you envisage for data centres?

Digitization followed by the 5G technology in communication will actually give a huge momentum to digitized business. India is still in 4G stage with a lot of digitization yet to happen, but the moment

5G comes into play most businesses would start adopting far more digitized models. Even as it will majorly impact the existing mega collaborative hyper data centers, 5G would move the market to edge computing, meaning every business will have to store some critical data near to the user or near to their functions. We see ourselves playing a major role in this space.

When it comes to Cloud, how does Delta see itself as a major player?

Cloud is another space that India has potential to grow exponentially. Many hyper-scaler companies are going to invest in India and top players are in some way established in India either directly or through collaborative partner. In fact, in the next 5-6 years we will see a huge boom of data centres where the current installed capacity of 500-600 MW data centres will have add on five times the current capacity each year. There will be projects of more than 300 MW and Delta is already in discussions with some investors. Cloud will have increasing impact on business models such as e-retail shops, banking etc. In fact, top 4-5 collo-players in all the segments including government and private is where Delta has significant presence.

What are the kind of data centres that Delta provides?

Delta caters to two kinds of segments, the traditional data centres where infrastructure needs i.e., the UPS, batteries and distribution units, which is the component portion, is provided and the other is engineered-to- order solution where we have skilled architectures in our data centres and have power containers that will be further